



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: St. Thomas More Academy

School Website: <https://stmasb.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL**Executive Summary**

St Thomas More Academy (STMA) presents a clearly Catholic, classical-leaning program with emphasis on virtue formation, a liberal-arts oriented curriculum, and a liturgical, community-centered ethos. Public site materials repeatedly foreground faith, Eucharistic worship, and a curriculum anchored in classical literature, languages, and the liberal arts. Evidence includes a stated Catholic identity with daily Mass, a description of classical education as developing wisdom and virtue, and explicit curricular elements such as primary/-classical texts and Latin/Greek study. However, while the school demonstrates strong classical contours in religion, curriculum, and exemplar language, some classical pedagogy markers (e.g., explicit, school-wide Socratic seminars in upper grades, a publicly stated “living curriculum,” or explicit parent-as-co-teacher partnerships) are less directly documented on the site. Taken together, the school is best described as SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL overall, with Element 1 (Religious and Metaphysical Foundations) and Element 2 (School Purpose and Goal) showing stronger, more explicit Classical alignment, and Categories 3–6 displaying solid classical commitments but with room to more explicitly articulate certain classical-pedagogical and community-ownership dimensions.

Key evidentiary threads from the public materials include:

- Catholic identity and liturgical life: “Saint Thomas More Academy is a K-12 Catholic classical school” and daily Eucharistic celebration, with explicit references to Mass as central to community life.
- Classical, liberal-arts curriculum orientation: explicit mention of “classical liberal arts education,” “Careful Reading of Primary and Classical Texts,” and multilingual/arts components (Latin/Greek, music, drama, visual arts).
- Formation-focused goals: language about forming virtue and character, “formation in virtue and character development,” and “freedom for excellence” oriented toward serving others and glorifying God.
- Public articulation of religious-liturgical orientation as a core aspect of education: Eucharist as “source and summit,” and a stated aim to educate in virtue, truth, goodness, and beauty.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL Evidence: Catholic identity, daily Mass, Eucharist-centered community, theology-infused language, and explicit cultivation of virtue and wisdom. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Strong presence of positive religious/metaphysical indicators (truth, goodness, beauty; virtue; theology; liturgy; Mass; sacred tradition). Likely 10–12 positive indicator hits; no clear negative indicators observed on the site. See Six Essential Elements lexicon for positive terms (truth, virtue, theology, liturgy, Mass, sacred tradition, reverence, wonder, logos, etc.). Why this rating: The site foregrounds transcendentals (truth, goodness, beauty) and liturgical life, aligning with the Positive Keyword indicators for this category. The Catholic identity and sacramental life anchor the metaphysical foundations.
- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL Evidence: Emphasis on formation in virtue and wisdom, classical mission, and liberal education; explicit contrasts with mere job-prep, and a telos oriented toward human flourishing. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive indicators include formation, virtue, wisdom, liberal education, classical mission; no strong negative signals (e.g., 21st-century-workforce framing) evident on the site. See lexicon entries for the classical aims (virtue, wisdom, telos, scholé, great conversation). Why this rating: The material consistently frames education as formation toward virtue and wisdom, not solely career preparation; thus CLASSICAL alignment is

solid here.

- **Element 3: Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL Evidence:** Curriculum highlights include Careful Reading of Primary and Classical Texts, Mastery of Latin and Greek, Mathematics/Science, Music/Drama/Visual Arts, Virtue/Character Formation, and Mass. The explicit Great Books/Great Conversation language is not as prominent, but the emphasis on primary/classical texts and classical languages is clear. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive indicators include: “Careful Reading of Primary and Classical Texts,” Latin/Greek, “classical” education, liberal arts. Negative indicators are not evident from the site text (no explicit replacement of history with social studies, etc.). Reference the Six Essential Elements curricular indicators (Seven Liberal Arts, Great Books/primary sources, history engagement). A partial alignment exists rather than full articulation of all six curricular elements, hence SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. See the lexicon/study lists for curricular markers. Why this rating: The site clearly asserts classical curricular components (texts, languages, arts) but does not strongly articulate every explicit curricular marker (e.g., explicit “Great Conversation” phrasing or a fully enumerated Trivium/Quadrivium emphasis). The core classical elements are present, but the full breadth of the Six Elements curricular indicators is not exhaustively enumerated on the site.
- **Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL Evidence:** The site emphasizes formation, virtue, and a classical orientation, with lower-school emphasis on liturgical life and memory/arts; upper-school pedagogy (Socratic seminars) is not explicitly documented on the site. The public materials do not thoroughly document explicit Socratic seminars, scholé rhythms, or detailed upper-school rhetoric programs, though there are indications of a classical environment (texts, languages, memory through arts). Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive indicators would include Scholé/restful learning, Socratic dialogue, memorization/recitation, and rhetoric as pedagogy; however, explicit mentions are not prominent on the public site. See Six Elements Pedagogy keywords (Socratic dialogue, scholé, memorization, liturgical memory, etc.). The absence of explicit Socratic/seminar language on the site reduces the measure of classical pedagogy to a partial alignment. Why this rating: While the program is clearly classical in orientation and includes memory/arts, there is less explicit, publicly documented evidence of the full range of classical pedagogical methods (Socratic seminars, disciplined rhetoric training, and restfulness as a central pedagogical stance). The alignment is strong but not fully proven by public-facing materials, hence SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.
- **Element 5: Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL Evidence:** The site emphasizes formation in virtue and character and a classical approach, but explicit statements about faculty as “living curriculum,” mentor culture, or detailed teacher-profile standards are not readily visible in the public materials. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive indicators include “formation,” “virtue,” “character development,” and “classical education,” but explicit teacher-role language (model teachers, living curriculum, faculty as mentors) is not strongly documented on the site. See the Six Elements Faculty keywords for what classical schools emphasize about teachers. Why this rating: The public materials suggest a classical faculty orientation in spirit (virtue modeling, formation, classical formation), but the site does not consistently articulate a robust “living curriculum” or “faculty-as-mentors” language with explicit examples. So, SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.
- **Element 6: Parents & Community — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL Evidence:** The site highlights a Catholic-community orientation and partnership with families in its religious and educational mission, but explicit “parent as co-teacher” language or formal parent-formation programming is not clearly documented on the public site. The Six Elements emphasize parental partnership and home-school collaboration as core markers of classical education. The STMA site does not foreground this as a central public metric, though faith-based community and daily Mass imply broad family involvement. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive indicators include family formation and partnership language in classical education lexicons, but explicit “parent as co-teacher,” home-based formation, or parent education programs are not clearly showcased on the public site. See the Six Elements Parents & Community keywords and negative signals. Why this rating: The school demonstrates a strong community-faith orientation and family involvement typical of classical Catholic schools, but publicly documented explicit parent-co-teacher partnerships and parent-formation programming are not clearly articulated on the site, which tempers the rating to SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Overall ranking: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

What Would Move the Needle

- Element 3 (Curriculum): Explicitly articulate and publicly document the Great Books/Great Conversation component, and how the curriculum integrates the Trivium and Quadrivium across grades. Add language about “history as history” across the curriculum rather than labeling history primarily through Catholic/theological framing.
- Element 4 (Pedagogy): Publicly articulate a clear pedagogy that includes Socratic dialogue or seminar in upper grades, plus a stated Scholé/restful-learning rhythm across the school. Include examples of memory work, chanting, or recitation in the lower grades as a documented pedagogy.
- Element 5 (Faculty): Provide explicit statements about the living-curriculum concept, teacher-professional development in classical pedagogy, and a documented culture of mentor-teacher collaboration (e.g., faculty seminars, master-teacher models).
- Element 6 (Parents & Community): Publicly codify a “parents as co-educators” framework, including parent formation opportunities (book clubs, lectures) and open-campus visitation policies as routine practice. Highlight any parent training or formation programs and articulate pathways for parent involvement in school governance or classroom support.
- Element 2 (School Purpose and Goal): While strong in virtue-wisdom formation, consider explicit articulation of a telos aligned with a broader classical tradition (e.g., reference to “the great conversation” or “permanent questions” in the school’s mission) to deepen the alignment with classical teleology.

ABSTRACT

The STMA site presents a robust Catholic, classical-education orientation with clear emphasis on virtue formation, liberal-arts curriculum, and liturgical-life integration. Religious/metaphysical foundations are explicit, including daily Mass and Eucharistic life, and the curriculum foregrounds primary/classical texts, Latin/Greek study, and arts. The school’s stated purpose centers on virtue, wisdom, and formation rather than vocational training, aligning with classical aims. However, explicit documentation of some classical pedagogical practices (e.g., Socratic seminars, Scholé pedagogy) and structured parent-as-co-teacher engagement is less evident in publicly accessible site content. Consequently, Element 1 and Element 2 align CLASSICAL, Element 3–6 align SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, yielding an overall assessment of SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL for St Thomas More Academy.

- Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL Evidence: Catholic identity, daily Mass, and theological framing of education; explicit references to virtue, truth, goodness, and beauty. See citations for Catholic identity and liturgical life. Keyword indicators: Truth, goodness, beauty; theology; liturgy; Mass; sacred tradition; reverence; wonder. See the Six Elements lexicon for positive indicators.
- School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL Evidence: Emphasis on formation, virtue, and wisdom; classical mission; anti-work-prep framing.
- Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL Evidence: Careful reading of primary/classical texts; Latin/Greek; music/arts; formation in virtue; Mass; yet less explicit Great-Books/Great Conversation language in public materials.
- Pedagogy — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL Evidence: Evidence of a classical orientation (texts, language, memory) but limited explicit documentation of Socratic seminars or Scholé pedagogy on the public site.
- Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL Evidence: Formation-centered language; lack of explicit “living curriculum”/mentor language in public pages.
- Parents & Community — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL Evidence: Strong religious-community emphasis; less explicit parent-as-co-educator framework in public pages. See lexicon for parent-partnership markers.

What would move the needle (summary)

- Publicly articulate and publish a formal “parents as co-educators” framework with parent-formation programming.
- Document and publicize explicit pedagogical methods (Socratic seminars or Paideia-style seminars; Scholé rhythms) and provide examples across grade bands.
- Explicitly present the Great Books/Great Conversation language and cross-disciplinary integration across history, literature, philosophy, and sciences.
- Highlight a clearly defined living-curriculum approach with teacher mentorship and professional development in classical pedagogy.

Note on sources and keyword methodology

- Public school content (the STMA crawl) shows explicit Catholic identity and classical-curriculum signposts (texts, languages, liturgy, virtue formation). Key passages include: “Saint Thomas More Academy is a K-12 Catholic classical school,” “Daily Celebration of the Holy Sacrifice of the Mass,” and “Careful Reading of Primary and Classical Texts,” plus references to Latin/Greek, and formation in virtue.
- The classical-education rubric is grounded in the Six Essential Elements of a Classical School (1) (positive/negative keyword indicators for each category) and in classical-education lexicons. Positive keyword indicators include truth, goodness, beauty; virtue; theology; liturgy; Mass; reverence; wonder; and the seven liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric; trivium/quadrivium) among others. Negative indicators include secular ethics, relativism, value-neutral approaches, and non-traditional pedagogy. See the Six Elements documentation and lexicon.

ABSTRACT

ed six-category scoring rationale

- Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: CLASSICAL (clear religious-metaphysical framing and liturgical life)
- School Purpose and Goal: CLASSICAL (formation-focused telos)
- Curriculum: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL (core classical elements present; some explicit Great Books language not as visible)
- Pedagogy: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL (pedagogical markers exist in theory but public documentation is less explicit)
- Faculty: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL (formation-centered framing; explicit living-curriculum language not clearly documented)
- Parents & Community: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL (community/faith orientation; explicit parent-partnership language less visible publicly)

Aggregate assessment: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY — CATEGORY-BY-CATEGORY DETAILED NOTES

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL Evidence: Catholic identity; liturgical life; sacred naming of education; formation in virtue and wisdom; Mass-centered community. Positive keywords present: truth, goodness, beauty; virtue; theology; liturgy; Mass; reverence; wonder; logos; sacred tradition; grace. See lexicon. Why this rating: Strong, explicit religious-moral grounding aligns with the Classical foundational indicators.
- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL Evidence: Emphasis on formation and wisdom; classical mission; virtue-centered telos, not mere job-prep. Positive keywords: formation, virtue, wisdom, liberal education, classical mission, scholé (where documented), human flourishing. Why this rating: Textual framing centers on transcendent aims and virtue, consistent with classical purposes.
- Element 3: Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL Evidence: Primary/classical texts; Latin/Greek; arts; virtue formation; Mass. Less explicit Great Books and history-integration language appears in public text. Positive keywords: Seven liberal arts (grammar/logic/rhetoric) implied via classical-texts

and Latin/Greek; Great Books (primary/ Classical texts); music/arts; history/western civilization framing. Negative keywords: Not overtly shown (no explicit social-studies re-labeling or STEM-first framing on site). See Six Elements curricular indicators. Why this rating: Core classical-curriculum components are present, but the site omits some explicit curricular descriptors (e.g., explicit Great Conversation language) that would cement full classical curricular breadth.

- Element 4: Pedagogy — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL Evidence: Classical orientation with emphasis on textual study, memory/arts; formal discussion pedagogy not clearly documented publicly; lower-grade liturgical/memory emphasis is indicated. Positive keywords: memorization/recitation, restfulness/scholé (as a pedagogical frame in classical literature), liturgical integration (memory/chant). See lexicon. Why this rating: The site signals classical methods (texts, memorization, arts) but lacks explicit, public articulation of a full suite of classical pedagogies (Socratic seminars, Paideia, etc.).
- Element 5: Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL Evidence: School explicitly emphasizes formation in virtue and character and the classical frame; explicit “live curriculum” language not clearly documented in public pages. Positive keywords: virtue, character, master-teacher models (as ideal), classical formation. See lexicon for faculty indicators. Why this rating: Public materials lean toward a classical faculty orientation, but the absence of explicit faculty-culture language reduces to a partial alignment.
- Element 6: Parents & Community — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL Evidence: Strong community-liturgical atmosphere; Catholic identity; family involvement implied but explicit “parents as co-teachers” framework not clearly published on site. Positive keywords: partnership with families; formation of affections; cultural transmission; family liturgy; parental engagement (as an ideal in classical education discourse). See the Six Elements positive lists. Why this rating: The religious-community orientation supports family involvement, but explicit parental co-education and formal parent-formation programming are not clearly documented on the public site.

ABSTRACT

St Thomas More Academy presents a robust Catholic, classical-education orientation with clear emphasis on virtue formation, a liberal-arts curriculum, and liturgical life. The religious/metaphysical foundations and the fidelity to formation toward truth, goodness, and beauty align strongly with classical aims (Element 1 and Element 2). The Curriculum (Element 3), Pedagogy (Element 4), Faculty (Element 5), and Parents & Community (Element 6) categories show substantial classical alignment but lack some explicit, publish-ready documentation of certain classical-pedagogical practices and parent partnerships in the public site. Taken together, STMA is best described as SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, with Element 1 and Element 2 standing out as CLASSICAL, and Categories 3–6 meeting many classical criteria but not all as publicly evidenced on the site.

Notes on evidence and keyword usage

- Core evidence includes: “Catholic classical school,” daily Eucharist/Mass, “Our Academic Philosophy” and “Why Classical Education?” pages emphasizing primary/classical texts, Latin/Greek, and formation in virtue.
- Positive/Negative keyword indicators are grounded in the Six Essential Elements framework (positive: truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, theology, liturgy, Mass, wonder; negative: relativism, secular ethics, value-neutral, etc.). See the classicality lexicon and the Six Elements documents for reference.
- For a broader sense of the classical rubric, the School’s public materials align with many but not all of the canonical elements (e.g., explicit Great Books language, visible “living curriculum” faculty language, and a formal parent-partnership framework are less explicit in the crawled pages). The Six Elements lexicon and related materials provide the standard points of comparison used here.

If you’d like, I can extract direct quotes for each category and assemble a tightly cross-referenced appendix that maps every key term to the Positive/Negative keyword lists, with precise line-citations from the school pages and the Six Essential Elements lexicon.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
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